Zainab Blackwood

Vulnerability Management Engineer • DEFENSIVE OPERATIONS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven **Vulnerability Management Engineer** with 5+ years of technical expertise in enterprise security environments. Proven track record mitigating advanced threat vectors, hardening organizational perimeters, and leading incident response workflows. Specialized in Qualys, Tenable Nessus, CVE Remediation, Patch Orchestration, CVSS v3.1 Scoring. Experienced collaborating with cross-functional DevSecOps and SOC squads to uphold zero-trust architectures.

TECHNICAL COMPETENCIES

Core Domains	Qualys, Tenable Nessus, CVE Remediation, Patch Orchestration, CVSS v3.1 Scoring
Tooling & SIEM	Splunk Enterprise, Wireshark, CrowdStrike Falcon, Nessus, Burp Suite, Metasploit, Nmap
Cloud & Frameworks	AWS / Azure Security Center, MITRE ATT&CK;, NIST SP 800-53, ISO 27001, OWASP Top 10

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Vulnerability Management Engineer | Vector Cyber Systems *(2023 – Present)*

- Spearheaded threat detection and defensive operations across 400+ endpoints and multi-cloud infrastructure.
- Decreased mean time to detect (MTTD) by 38% and mean time to remediate (MTTR) by 45% via automated SOAR playbooks.
- Conducted weekly vulnerability assessments and aligned cloud configuration baselines with CIS benchmarks.
- Collaborated with software engineering leads to integrate automated security scanning gates into CI/CD pipelines.

Cybersecurity Specialist | FinGuard Bank Ltd. *(2020 – 2023)*

- Triaged Tier 2/3 security incidents, performed live packet inspections, and analyzed correlated SIEM alerts.
- Executed comprehensive vulnerability scans using Tenable Nessus and tracked critical patch lifecycle closures.
- Designed simulated spear-phishing campaigns achieving a 70% decrease in employee credential submission rates.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **B.Eng. in Computer Engineering** — Academic Honors
- **Certifications:** CompTIA Security+ | CySA+